

065 Bury a beetle bucket

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MINS

Many beetles make their homes on the moist forest floor amid decaying wood and leaves. Sadly, some are vanishing due to habitat loss. This beetle bucket could help your local beetles survive.



What you need

- Plastic bucket
- Craft knife
- Stones
- Bark chippings
- Shovel
- Logs
- Garden soil



1 Cut 1 in (3 cm) holes in the sides and bottom of the bucket for entryways. Choose a location that won't be disturbed.



2 Bury the bucket in a deep hole. Put large stones in the bottom, then add one or two logs (oak is best); stand them on end.



3 Fill the bucket with bark chippings, then a little soil. Female beetles will lay their eggs on the logs, and the larvae will eat the wood as it decays.



4 Put some logs on top of the bucket to mark the site and leave the area undisturbed. Other beetles will use the logs on top, as well as those in the bucket.

066 Tell a bug from a beetle

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There are over 350,000 different types of beetle. Most have hard wing cases that hide their hind wings. Their mandibles are used for chewing food instead of sucking up liquid like a bug does.

